

# Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

## **Problem Statement:**

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

## **User Story:**

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

## **Project Objective:**

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

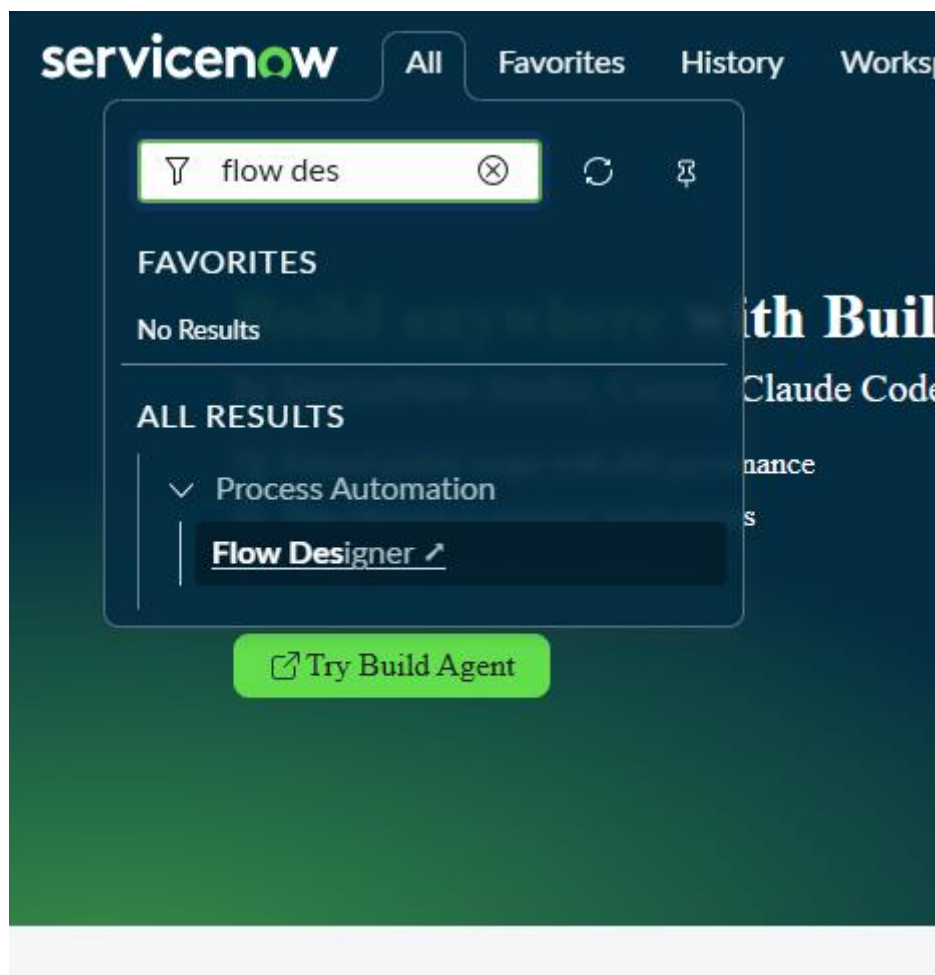
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

## TASK INITIATION

### Milestone 1 : Flow

**Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.**

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



Homepage Operations Integrations

Playbooks **Flows** Subflows Triggers Actions Decision tables

New ▾

- Playbook
- Flow**
- Subflow
- Trigger
- Action
- Decision table
- Help me decide

Pick up where you left off

- Standard laptop task**  
Last updated: 24 min. ago by Syst...
- Sub-Production tasks**  
Last updated: 10 months ago by ...
- Production tasks**  
Last updated: a year ago by Syste...

Latest updates

- System Administrator modified [Standard laptop task](#)  
24 min. ago
- System Administrator modified [Sub-Production tasks](#)  
10 months ago
- Custom Administrator modified

Flows

Last refreshed 33m ago.

| Name                                         | Application        | Status    | Active |          |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------|--------|----------|
| Application Intake Request Flow (Deprecated) | Application Intake | Published | false  |          |
| Application Intake Request V2                | Application Intake | Published | true   |          |
| Benchmark Recommendation Evaluator           | Benchmarks Spoke   | Published | true   | 2026-04- |
| Business process approval flow               | Global             | Published | true   | 2020-09- |
| Change - Cloud Infrastructure - Authorize    | Global             | Published | true   | 2020-11- |
| Change - Conflict Detection                  | Global             | Published | true   | 2026-04- |
| Change - Emergency - Authorize               | Global             | Published | true   | 2020-10- |

Workflow Studio

Let's get the details for your flow

Name to uniquely identify your flow.

Flow name \*

standard laptop task

Application \*

Global

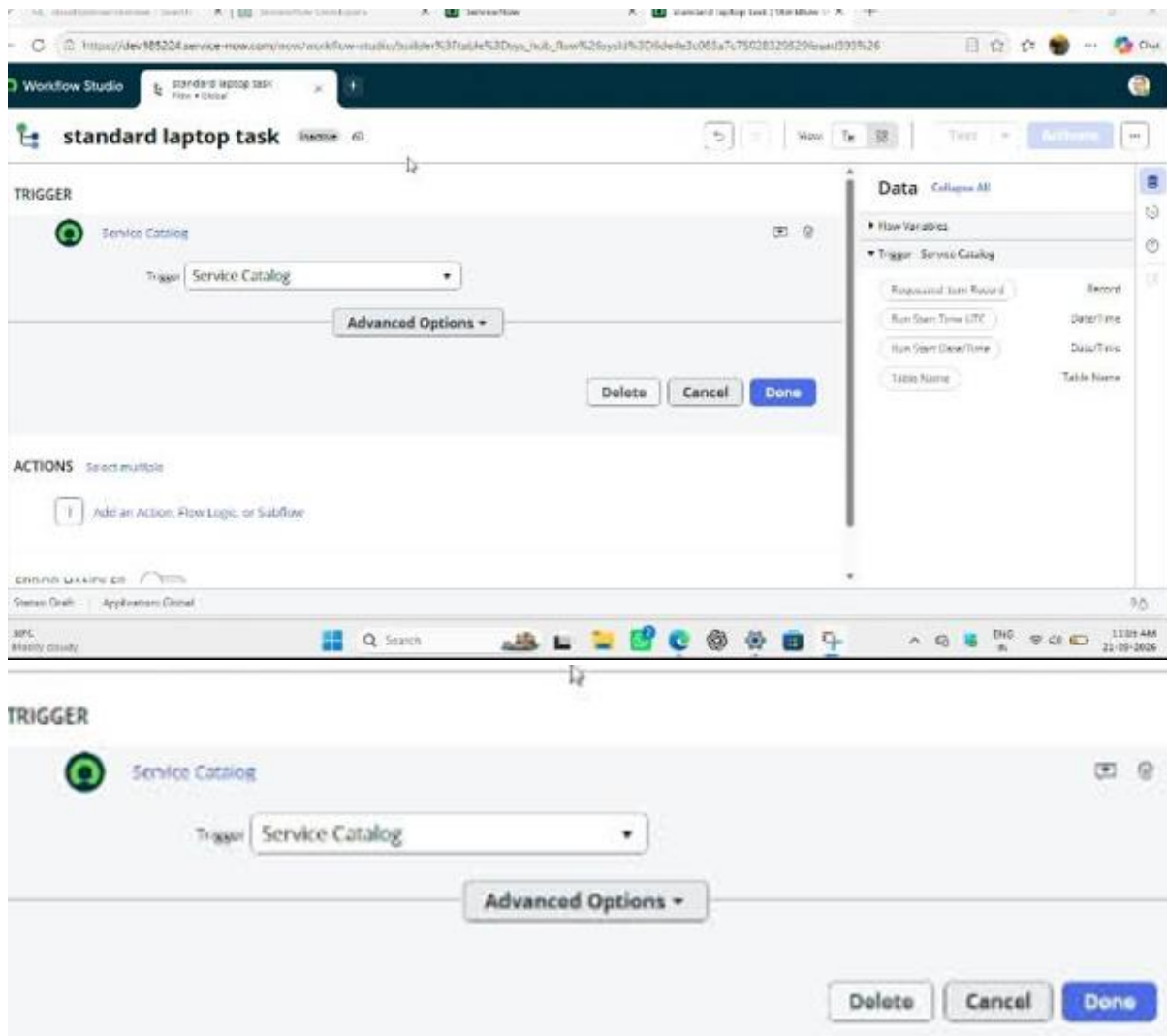
Description \*

Describe your flow.

> Show additional properties

Cancel Build flow

- Click on Add a trigger
- Select the trigger in that Search for "Service Catalog" and select that.
- After that click on Done.



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Workflow Studio | standard laptop task | **Inactive** | **Activate**

**ACTIONS** Select multiple

Search Actions

- Most Recent
- Popular
- ServiceNow Core
- AI Troubleshooting
- CMD8 Workspace
- Collaboration Services fo...
- Common Guidances
- Connect

Default

- Add Worknote Link to Cont...
- Ask For Approval
- Create or Update Record
- Create Record
- Create Task
- Delete Record
- Fire Event
- Get Email Header

**Data** Collapse All

Flow Variables

Trigger: Service Catalog

|                       |            |
|-----------------------|------------|
| Requested Item Record | Record     |
| Run Start Time UTC    | Date/Time  |
| Run Start Date/Time   | Date/Time  |
| Table Name            | Table Name |

Standard Draft | Application: Global

30°C Mostly cloudy

Workflow Studio | standard laptop task | **Inactive** | **Test** | **Activate**

1. **Create Catalog Task**

**Action Properties**

Action: Create Catalog Task

**Action Inputs**

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc.task]

Requested Item (Requested Item): Drag and drop Requested Item pill

Short Description:

Fields: + Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item

**Data** Collapse All

Flow Variables

Trigger: Service Catalog

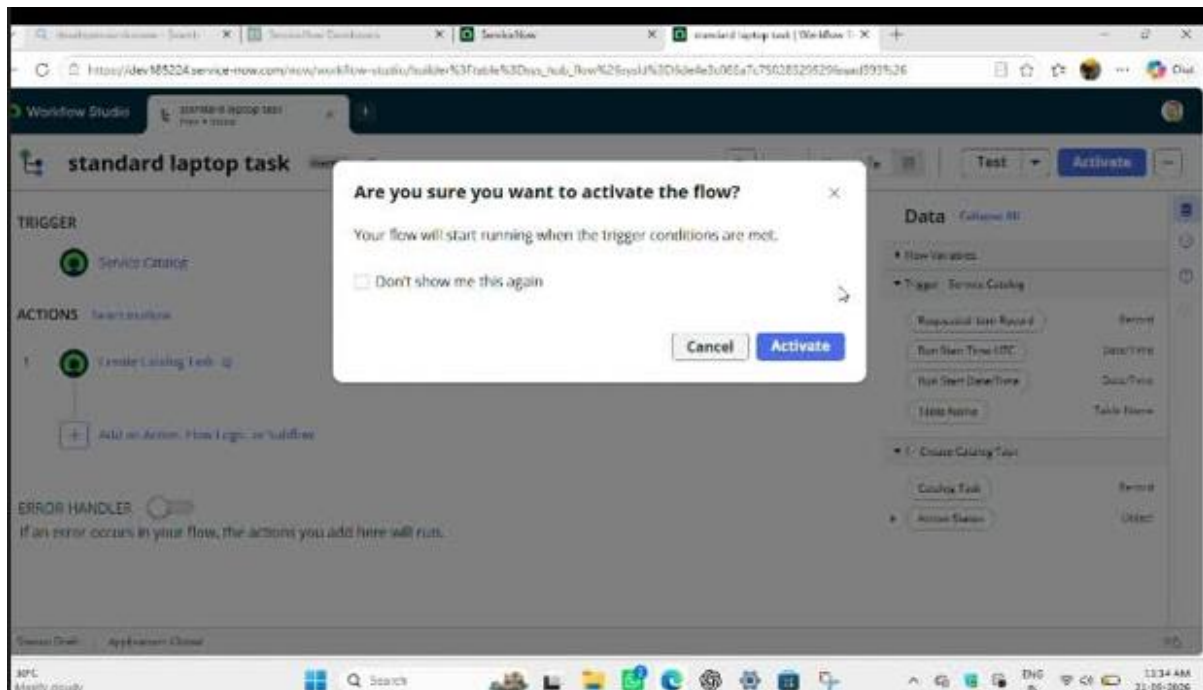
|                       |            |
|-----------------------|------------|
| Requested Item Record | Record     |
| Run Start Time UTC    | Date/Time  |
| Run Start Date/Time   | Date/Time  |
| Table Name            | Table Name |

1. Create Catalog Task

|               |        |
|---------------|--------|
| Catalog Task  | Record |
| Action Status | Object |

Standard Draft | Application: Global

30°C Mostly cloudy



## Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

### Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.



Catalog Items

Name

Search

ⓘ

Actions on selected rows...

All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published Item is empty > Name >= standard laptop

| <input type="checkbox"/> | Q | Name ▲                                    | Short description     | Active | Roles  | Catalogs        | Category    | Price      | Type      | Updated             |
|--------------------------|---|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|-----------------|-------------|------------|-----------|---------------------|
|                          |   | Search                                    | Search                | Search | Search | Search          | Search      | Search     | !=Package | Search              |
|                          |   | Standard Laptop                           | Lenovo - Carbon x1    | true   |        | Service Catalog | Hardware    | \$1,100.00 | Item      | 2026-09-20 23:52:52 |
|                          |   | StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter | PC / Mac Compatible   | false  |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$17.23    | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
|                          |   | StarTech Mini Display Port to VGA Adapter | PC / Mac Compatible   | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$24.50    | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
|                          |   | StarTech USB Mini Hub                     | 4 Port, USB 2.0       | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$11.55    | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
|                          |   | StarTech USB to DVI Adapter               | Multi Monitor Adapter | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$49.99    | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
|                          |   | STM MacBook Air Sleeve                    | STM Mac Sleeve - S13" | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$24.26    | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
|                          |   | STM MacBook Pro Sleeve                    | STM Mac Sleeve - S15" | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$25.78    | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |

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Catalog Item

Standard Laptop

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Copy

Try It

Update

Edit in Catalog Builder

Delete

↑

↓

ⓘ Build and modify items faster with the improved [Catalog Builder](#).

Catalog Items are goods or services available to order from the service catalog. Items can be anything from hardware, like tablets and phones, to software applications, to furniture and office supplies.

- Enter a Name and Short description to display for the item.
- Enter a Price, approvals, variables, and other information as needed.

Name

Standard Laptop

Catalogs

Service Catalog

Category

Hardware

State

-- None --

Checked out

-- None --

Owner

Secondary owners

Application

Global

Active

☒

Fulfillment automation level

Unspecified

## Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

### Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.





[Service Catalog](#) > [Hardware](#) > [Standard Laptop](#)

**Lenovo - Carbon x1**  
**x1 Carbon**  
The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.  
Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

  
Optional Software

- ☒ Adobe Acrobat
- ☐ Adobe Photoshop

  
Additional software requirements

**Order this Item**  
Price \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually  
Quantity   
Subtotal \$1,100.00 + \$100.00 Annually  
Delivery time 0 Days  
[Order Now](#)  
[Add to Cart](#)  
**Shopping Cart**  
Empty

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

**Order Status**

[Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2026-09-20 23:54:41  
Request Number: [REQ0010001](#) ☆  
Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2026-09-20

| Description (Includes Annual Charges) | Delivery Date | Stage | Price (ea.)                      | Quantity     | Total                                    |
|---------------------------------------|---------------|-------|----------------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Lenovo - Carbon x1</a>    | 2026-09-20    | ▶     | \$1,100.00<br>+\$100.00 Annually | 1            | \$1,100.00<br>+\$100.00 Annually         |
|                                       |               |       |                                  | <b>Total</b> | <b>\$1,100.00<br/>+\$100.00 Annually</b> |

[Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

[Requested Items \(1\)](#) [Approvers \(1\)](#) [Group approvals \(1\)](#) [Recurring Prices \(1\)](#)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2026-09-20 23:54:52 |

- Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

[Update](#) [Add New Item](#) [Cancel Request](#) [Copy](#) [Delete](#)

[Requested Items \(1\)](#) [Approvals \(1\)](#) [Recurring Prices \(1\)](#)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

State Approver Comments Created

Requested Eric Schroeder 2026-09-20 23:54:52

Show Matching  
Filter Out  
Copy URL to Clipboard  
Copy sys\_id  
Assign Tag  
Approve  
Reject

- Then click on the Requested item Section
- Open that Requested Item record



Update Delete

Related Links  
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers

Number Search Actions on selected rows... New

Request item = RITM0010001

|                          | Number                        | Assignment group | Assigned to | Short description         | Actual start        | Actual end | Order |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------|-------------|---------------------------|---------------------|------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | <a href="#">SCTASK0010001</a> | Hardware         | (empty)     | Laptop need to Configured | 2026-09-20 23:55:44 | (empty)    |       |

12. Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

< Catalog Task SCTASK0010001 Discuss Follow Update Close Task Delete

Number

Assigned to

Configuration item

Active ☒

Approval

Priority

State

Request item

Requested for

Short description

Description

Comments (Customer visible)

☐ Work notes Post

Activities: 1 System Administrator Field changes • 2026-09-20 23:55:44

## Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.